

MAC ADMINS INDIA CONNECT 2026 • THE GIVEAWAY

The Mac Admin Starter Kit

Everything a new Apple admin needs to get moving — the 4 C's, a 90-day plan, checklists, real starter scripts, a curated resource map, and a plain-English glossary.



Curiosity

Stay a learner



Command

Own the fundamentals



Code

Automate yourself



Community

Never go it alone

Curated by

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Engage • Empower • Elevate



Join the community

Welcome, new Mac Admin

This kit is your launchpad. You don't need to know everything on day one — you need a direction. That's the 4 C's: a simple compass you can come back to for your whole career. Skim the whole kit once, then keep it handy and work one section at a time.



Curiosity

Treat every error as a lesson. Keep a lab. Keep asking why. Curiosity is what turns a task-doer into a problem-solver.



Command

Own the fundamentals — the Mac platform, your MDM, and security. Depth in the basics beats shallow knowledge of everything.



Code

If you do it twice, script it. A little automation compounds into hours saved every week and fewer mistakes.



Community

You are never alone. The Mac Admins community will unblock you faster than anything else — and you'll pay it forward.

The 4 C's in action

Two concrete moves for each C. Pick one this week.



Curiosity

- Build a home lab — a spare Mac or a VM you can safely break.
- Skim Apple's release notes and a MacAdmins newsletter every week.



Command

- Learn one MDM deeply: enrollment, profiles, policies, smart groups.
- Make FileVault, patching and a compliance baseline second nature.



Code

- Automate your single most-repeated task this month.
- Learn shell/zsh first; add Python when you outgrow it.



Community

- Join #macadminsindia and post your first question this week.
- Find a mentor through the Mac Admins India program — or become one.

Your first 90 days

LEARN

Days 1–30

- Get your lab running; enroll a test Mac end-to-end.
- Learn your MDM's core: enrollment, profiles, policies, groups.
- Read Apple Platform Deployment basics.
- Shadow a senior admin and ask 'why' a lot.

CONTRIBUTE

Days 31–60

- Take ownership of one small workflow (an app deploy, a profile).
- Write your first automation script — put it in version control.
- Answer one question in #macadminsindia.
- Document one process the team was missing.

OWN

Days 61–90

- Own onboarding for a team or device group.
- Build a repeatable, documented, monitored process.
- Automate a second painful task end-to-end.
- Share something you learned back to the team or community.

New Mac onboarding checklist



Enroll via zero-touch

Automated Device Enrollment so the Mac configures itself out of the box.



Scope it correctly

Assign the device to the right MDM group so it gets the right settings.



Enforce FileVault

Turn on disk encryption and escrow the recovery key to your MDM.



Deploy the baseline apps

Browser, VPN, security agent, productivity — your standard set.



Apply configuration profiles

Wi-Fi, restrictions, and privacy (PPPC/TCC) approvals.



Confirm patching

Make sure the software-update / patch policy is applied and reporting.



Set up identity

Local account or Platform SSO — however your org signs in.



Verify compliance

Check the device is green in your MDM dashboard before handover.



Hand over warmly

Give the user a short 'getting started' note — first impressions matter.

The 7-step triage flow

Resist the urge to reimage first. Work the problem in order — it's faster and it keeps the user's trust.

1

Reproduce & gather

Get the exact symptom, when it started, and what changed.

2

Check the basics

Restart, storage, updates, network — the usual suspects first.

3

Read the logs

Console.app / log show, and confirm the device's MDM check-in.

4

Isolate the variable

Another user? A fresh profile? Safe mode? Narrow it down.

5

Search before you sweat

MacAdmins Slack + docs — someone has likely seen it.

6

Fix in a pilot ring

Validate the fix on a few machines before touching production.

7

Document it

Write down the fix so future-you and the team benefit.

Scripts I — know your Mac

Safe, everyday commands. Test in your lab first; some need sudo.

Device facts every admin should be able to pull

```
#!/bin/zsh
# Serial number
system_profiler SPHardwareDataType | awk '/Serial/ {print $4}'
# Hardware model identifier
sysctl -n hw.model
# macOS version and build
sw_vers
# Computer name
scutil --get ComputerName
# The real logged-in (console) user
stat -f%Su /dev/console
```

Security & enrollment status

```
#!/bin/zsh
# FileVault (disk encryption) status
fdsetup status
# MDM enrollment status
profiles status -type enrollment
# List installed configuration profiles
sudo profiles list
# Check for available macOS software updates
softwareupdate --list
```

Why these matter

- These are the first questions you'll answer on almost every ticket.
- Wrap them in a single script and you've built your first 'device info' tool.
- Everything read-only here is safe to run; commands with sudo change state — know what they do first.

Scripts II — manage & maintain

Jamf basics (Jamf-managed Macs)

```
#!/bin/zsh
# Check in and run any policies that are due
sudo jamf policy
# Update inventory (send fresh data to Jamf Pro)
sudo jamf recon
# Test the connection to your Jamf Pro server
sudo jamf checkJSSConnection
# Show the management framework version
jamf version
```

Housekeeping & quick fixes

```
#!/bin/zsh
# Free disk space (human readable)
df -h /
# 10 largest items in the home folder
du -sh ~/* 2>/dev/null | sort -rh | head -10
# Battery cycle count & condition
system_profiler SPPowerDataType | grep -A1 'Cycle Count'
# Flush DNS cache (common connectivity fix)
sudo dscacheutil -flushcache
sudo killall -HUP mDNSResponder
```

Level-up path

- Put your scripts in a Git repo — version control is a superpower, not overhead.
- Turn winning scripts into MDM policies/extension attributes so they run at scale.
- Explore Installomator and AutoPkg to automate app packaging and patching.

Resource directory



Start here — communities

If you only bookmark one section, make it this one. These are the people who will unblock you.

- **Mac Admins Slack**
40k+ admins, a channel for everything. Join #macadminsindia first.
- **Mac Admins India**
Your local community — Telegram, monthly huddles & tech sessions.
- **Jamf Nation (Jamf Community)**
Jamf's own Q&A community, guides and product forums.
- **Mac Admins Europe**
For the community, by the community — a European event archive.
- **Mac Admins Foundation**
The non-profit behind the Slack, the podcast and much more.
- **r/macsysadmin**
Reddit's Mac systems-admin community.



Master resource lists

Curated, community-maintained directories. When you don't know where to look, look here.

- **Awesome Mac Admin Tools** · [smashism](#)
The community's big curated list of tools. PRs welcome.
- **The Definitive MacAdmins Resource Directory** · [Mark Mahabir](#)
A living, all-in-one directory of Mac admin resources.
- **Navigating Apple** · [Apple Benelux SE team](#)
An extensive bookmark set covering everything Apple.
- **Community is Valuable (the inspiration)** · [Jordy Théry](#)
The Jamf Nation post this directory grew from.
- **University of Utah MacAdmins streams**
20+ years of Mac admin talks, slides and audio.



News, blogs & the people behind them

Follow a few of these and you'll absorb the craft almost by osmosis.

- **Jamf Blog** · [Jamf](#)
News and how-tos across the Jamf world.
- **Mac Admins News** · [Armin Briegel](#)
The weekly newsletter that keeps you current.
- **Scripting OS X** · [Armin Briegel](#)
The go-to for shell scripting & macOS (creator of Installinator).
- **Der Flounder** · [Rich Trouton](#)
Deep, reliable how-tos on packaging, security and more.
- **Mr. Macintosh**
Release news, update tracking and rescue guides (incl. DFU).
- **Krypted** · [Charles Edge \(in memoriam\)](#)
A cornerstone of the community. Thank you, for everything.
- **Snelson.us** · [Dan K. Snelson](#)
Home of Setup-Your-Mac and great enrollment write-ups.
- **Travelling Tech Guy** · [Frederik Abeloos](#)
Sharp technical articles, especially on Jamf Connect.
- **Motionbug** · [Rob Potvin](#)
Practical Jamf & Apple management, incl. VMs.
- **Modtitan** · [Emily Kausalik](#)
Mac management insight from a Foundation co-founder.
- **Graham R Pugh**
Creator of Erase-install, used worldwide to (re)install macOS.
- **MacMule** · [Ben Toms](#)
Loads of well-loved, battle-tested topics.
- **AppleShareIT** · [Mischa van der Bent](#)
Scripts & tips — home of SetDock and much more.
- **Boberito** · [Bob Gendler](#)
Security deep-dives; contributor to the mSCP project.
- **Rocketman.tech blog**
Apple-only MSP; hosts the LaunchPad user group (US).

RESOURCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

- **HCS Technology Group white papers**
Extensive setup write-ups (great for DEPNotify & more).

Learn & get certified

Structured ways to turn curiosity into real skill.

- **Apple Platform Deployment** · [Apple](#)
The official source of truth for deploying Apple devices.
- **Jamf Training & Certification** · [Jamf](#)
Jamf 100 / 170 / 200 / 300 / 400 — build (and badge) real skills.
- **Jamf Concepts** · [Jamf](#)
Solutions & plug-ins for the Jamf ecosystem, built by Jamfs.

Essential tools & open source

The projects seasoned admins reach for again and again.

- **swiftDialog** · [Bart Reardon](#)
Beautiful custom dialogs, messages and input forms.
- **Installinator** · [Armin Briegel](#)
Install & patch apps by label — a Mac admin staple.
- **App Auto-Patch** · [Robert Schroeder](#)
Uses Installinator to keep all apps up to date.
- **Nudge** · [Erik Gomez](#)
Strongly encourages users to run macOS updates.
- **S.U.P.E.R.M.A.N. (super)** · [Kevin M. White](#)
Optimises the whole macOS update experience.
- **Munki** · [Walt Disney Animation Studios](#)
Powerful software install/removal management for macOS.
- **Setup-Your-Mac** · [Dan K. Snelson](#)
A polished, guided enrollment experience.
- **Jamf Setup Manager** · [Jamf](#)
Native enrollment-progress tool.
- **Escrow Buddy** · [Netflix](#)
Generates & escrows FileVault recovery keys via MDM.

RESOURCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

- **macOS Security Compliance Project** · [NIST + community](#)
Baselines to harden and audit macOS.
- **Jamf Compliance Editor** · [Jamf](#)
Build mSCP baselines straight into Jamf.
- **JamfCheck** · [Thijs Xhaflaire](#)
Quick health checks for Jamf Pro, Connect & Protect.
- **Support App** · [Root3](#)
A customisable macOS menu-bar support app.
- **IBM Notifier** · [IBM](#)
Interactive popups and notification banners.
- **SchoolAssembly** · [Anthony Darlow](#)
App deployment/onboarding for Jamf School.
- **Uninstaller** · [Erik Stam](#)
Installomator in reverse — uninstall apps by recipe.
- **Desktoppr** · [Armin Briegel](#)
Set the desktop wallpaper from a script.
- **Dockutil** · [Kyle Crawford](#)
Manage the macOS Dock from scripts.
- **XCreds** · [Twocanoes](#)
Cloud-identity login for the Mac (a Jamf Connect alternative).
- **Erase-install** · [Graham Pugh](#)
Wipe, reinstall or upgrade macOS reliably.
- **MIST** · [Ninxsoft](#)
Auto-download macOS firmwares & installers (great for VMs).
- **Download Full Installer** · [Armin Briegel](#)
Fetch full macOS installer pkgs from a simple UI.
- **UTM** · [utmapp](#)
Run macOS/Windows/Linux VMs on your Mac — perfect for a lab.
- **Crystal Fetch** · [Turing Software](#)
Build a Windows installer ISO for VMs.
- **Jamf PPC Utility** · [Jamf](#)
Drag-and-drop builder for PPC/privacy profiles.
- **iMazing Profile Editor** · [DigiDNA](#)
Visually author configuration profiles.

RESOURCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

- **MDM Watchdog** · [Addigy](#)
Surfaces MDM connectivity problems — any MDM.
- **DFU Blaster** · [Twocanoes](#)
One-click DFU mode + restore any supported macOS.
- **Suspicious Package / Apparency** · [Mothers Ruin Software](#)
Inspect installer packages and app bundles.



Conferences & podcasts

Where the community gathers, learns and laughs together.

- **Mac Admins India Connect (MAIC)**
The community's flagship India event — you're here!
- **JNUC (Jamf Nation User Conference)** · [Jamf](#)
The big annual Jamf gathering (US).
- **Penn State MacAdmins**
Long-running community conference; many talks online (US).
- **MacSysAdmin**
Respected Apple-admin conference (Sweden, EU).
- **MacADUK**
The UK's Apple admin conference.
- **Mac Admins Europe**
Community-driven European event.
- **Mac Admins Podcast** · [MacAdmins Foundation](#)
Weekly conversations with the tool-builders.
- **Jamf After Dark** · [Jamf](#)
Jamf's own podcast.
- **Apple @ Work** · [9to5Mac](#)
Enterprise Apple news & interviews.

Glossary — the essentials

MDM

Mobile Device Management — the system that remotely configures & secures devices.

ADE / DEP

Automated Device Enrollment — zero-touch setup straight out of the box.

ABM / ASM

Apple Business/School Manager — where devices & apps are assigned.

APNs

Apple Push Notification service — how the MDM 'nudges' a device to check in.

Configuration Profile

A file of settings (payloads) the MDM applies to a device.

Supervision

A higher level of MDM control for org-owned devices.

FileVault

Apple's full-disk encryption; escrow the recovery key to your MDM.

Bootstrap Token

A key that lets MDM authorize secure actions like updates.

Gatekeeper / XProtect

macOS defenses that check apps for signing & known malware.

TCC / PPC

Privacy controls; PPC profiles pre-approve app access to data.

System Extension

Modern replacement for kernel extensions (kexts).

Smart Group (Jamf)

A dynamic device group based on criteria you define.

Recon (Jamf)

Inventory collection — sends current device data to Jamf Pro.

Installomator / AutoPkg

Tools that automate app download, packaging & updates.

Platform SSO

Sign in to the Mac with your cloud identity (Entra, Okta, etc.).

DDM

Declarative Device Management — the newer, proactive MDM model.

THE MOST IMPORTANT C

You've got this.

Every admin in the room started where you are. The difference between staying stuck and leveling up is simple: stay curious, own the basics, automate the boring — and never go it alone.



MacAdmins Slack — #macadminsindia

40k+ admins worldwide · your 24/7 lifeline



Mac Admins India

Telegram, monthly huddles & tech sessions · macadmins.in



Mentorship Program

Get paired with a senior admin — or become one



YouTube · Jamf Nation

Recordings, guides and Q&A you can search anytime



Join Mac Admins India

Remember the 4 C's

Curiosity · Command · Code · Community

Engage · Empower · Elevate · Mac Admins India Connect 2026